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Negotiating language ideologies through imaginary play: Children's code choice and rescaling practices in Dominica, West Indies

Amy L. Paugh

James Madison University, Department of Sociology and Anthropology, 71 Alumnae Drive, MSC 7501, Harrisonburg, VA 22807, USA

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ABSTRACT

In Dominica, a process of language shift from Patwa, an Afro-French creole, to varieties of English, the official language, has been ongoing over several decades. English indexes higher scales of value related to its position as the language of government, education, and formal settings, while Patwa indexes lower scales related to its position as a predominantly rural, oral, informal language. Children are generally prohibited from speaking Patwa in adult-controlled settings and increasingly use English varieties. Adults, however, transmit competing language ideologies that both denigrate and valorize Patwa, indexically linking it to adult roles and age-graded expectations through their child language socialization practices. Children employ Patwa for particular functions during play with peers when out of the purview of adults. This study examines children's scaling practices and uses of space as they alternate between languages to enact vivid imaginary play scenarios and negotiate their shifting footings and stances in child-controlled settings. It analyzes how children try out and socialize one another into multilingual practices through their ludic interactions, focusing on one extended bout of imaginary role play in particular. Through play, children construct alternative social worlds in which competing scales of linguistic value are reconfigured within child-controlled spatiotemporal contexts.

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1. Introduction

Imaginary play is a productive site for exploring how children understand and socialize one another into multilingual practices and ideologies. On the Eastern Caribbean island of Dominica, children learn to communicate in the context of a language shift from Patwa, an Afro-French creole, to varieties of English, the official language, which has been ongoing for several decades (Paugh, 2012a). English indexes higher scales of value (Blommaert, 2010) related to its position as the language of government, education, and formal settings, while Patwa indexes lower scales related to its position as a predominantly rural, oral, informal language. Despite state revitalization efforts attempting to rescale Patwa as an endangered heritage language (cf. Meek, 2016; Mortimer, 2016), rural children are discouraged from speaking Patwa in adult-controlled settings and increasingly use English varieties. Adult multilingual practices, however, display competing language ideologies that both denigrate and valorize Patwa depending on the context, thereby reproducing dominant scalar relationships while also challenging them by valuing Patwa as a marker of community identity and preferred code for informal social interaction

E-mail address: paughal@jmu.edu.

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and expression of heightened affective stances. Language socialization practices with children indexically link Patwa to particular adult roles, spaces, and age-graded expectations of language use. This study examines how children negotiate these complex language ideologies and can reconfigure competing scales of linguistic value as they construct alternative social worlds through sociodramatic play in child-controlled spatiotemporal contexts.

During unmonitored peer play, many children employ Patwa as an "adult" register to assert authority and to set up complex imaginary scenarios (Paugh, 2005a, 2005b, 2012a). The analysis here focuses on one such example: a lengthy stretch of pretend play among one peer group as they alternate between English and Patwa varieties. The analytic framework applies a language socialization approach (Duranti et al., 2012; Ochs and Schieffelin, 2012) to space and scaling practices (Blommaert, 2010, 2015; Carr and Lempert, 2016; Mortimer, 2016) and frame and footing (Goffman, 1974, 1981) to show how children navigate and socialize one another into multilingual practices through their ludic interactions. Siblings, cousins, and non-kin peers create spaces in which it is appropriate to use both languages for enacting social identities otherwise not readily available to them, such as adult occupations. In doing so, they display complex uses and perceptions of both Patwa and English in ways that rescale the languages through their creative play, albeit temporarily and in particular spaces, and potentially socialize one another into new linguistic competencies that impact their language development over time. Combining the language socialization model with a study of scaling practices demonstrates in fine-grained detail how children contribute to sociolinguistic reproduction and change through their turn-by-turn linguistic constructions and shifts in footing that (dis) align participants with one another's actions, verbal moves, and orientations toward linguistic varieties.

2. Scaling practices and language socialization in children's multilingual play

The concept of scale offers a tool for reconceptualizing and complexifying understandings of the interactions between micro- and macro-processes, particularly in cases of linguistic contact (Blommaert, 2007, 2010, 2015; Blommaert et al., 2005; Blommaert et al., 2015; Collins et al., 2009). Scaling is a process "by which participants order a range of semiotic material through shifting participant alignments along interactionally produced sociotemporal clines" (Choksi, 2015:1; also Canagarajah and De Costa, 2016). Scaled hierarchies, as noted by Carr and Lempert (2016:3), "are the effects of efforts to sort, group, and categorize many things, people, and qualities in terms of relative degrees of elevation or centrality." Language can be employed to scale virtually anything, but language itself is also scaled through such things as metapramatic reflections, micro-level interactional practices, and macro-level policy decisions that draw distinctions (Carr and Lempert, 2016) between varieties, qualities, number of users, and other factors. The notion of scalar processes and relationships offers a way to approach language ideologies and how they mediate social practice by encompassing the horizontal moving of semiotic resources in interactions as well as hierarchical orders of meaning, power, and prestige that are contextually and variably relevant (Blommaert, 2015). As Mortimer (2016:60) states, "In any moment of interpretation or meaning making, a timespace scale is indexed, and whatever scale is invoked may be of a higher or lower position than another in the hierarchy."

Space, time, and power are important dimensions of scaling practices. Linguistic resources can be upscaled in particular settings as they are attributed "a higher level of relevance, truth, validity or value" (Blommaert, 2010:35), or downscaled when a language variety moves into contexts or spaces where it is less appropriate or desirable than another variety. Through such "scale-jumping" processes, certain resources may get pushed out through the spontaneous interactional moves, frames, and footings (Goffman, 1974, 1981) employed by participants, particularly as language users with different compentencies come into contact. Further, participants are unlikely to mobilize all their linguistic resources in any given space, thus certain spaces may make evident levels of competence that are not visible elsewhere (Blommaert, 2007; Blommaert et al., 2005). As Blommaert (2007:2, emphasis in original) reminds us, "space is not a passive background but an *agentive* force in sociolinguistic processes, notably in the assessment of competencies." One may gain or lose "competence" by moving through different spaces over time given their varying demands and expectations, with power relations produced by "the asymmetrical capacity to invoke particular scale-levels in the interpretation of an act" (Blommaert, 2010:36). Mortimer (2016), for example, shows how a change in educational policy to teach the indigenous language Guarani in schools in Paraguay has been of more benefit to Spanish dominant students than minoritized Guarani dominant students. Through avoidance of being labeled as indigenous and downscaling of certain sociolinguistic resources (like Jopara, a local variety of Guarani) vis-à-vis "school Guarani" and Spanish, policy remains distinct from practice and leads to Guarani-dominant children being educated in Spanish rather than home languages. These persistent inequalities can be addressed and marginalized students can be empowered, Mortimer (2016:67) suggests, through the rescaling and upscaling of linguistic resources and the social identities they index in such spaces as schools.

Combining a language socialization perspective with the notion of scale can offer insights into the multiplex scales of indexicality and value that organize social life and language use in new ways (Mortimer & Wortham 2015), illuminating on how such scales are brought into being, reproduced, and challenged across the generations. Language socialization researchers examine how children and other novices are socialized through language as they learn to use language (Duranti et al., 2012; Ochs and Schieffelin, 2012; also Garrett and Baquedano-López, 2002; Paugh, 2016). Through everyday social interaction with those around them, children learn discursive practices as well as the language ideologies and scalar hierarchies that render such practices meaningful within their cultural contexts. Central to understanding how language socialization and language ideologies function in social life is the concept of indexicality, the capacity of linguistic forms, including grammar and discourse features like language choice, to point to or index sociocultural information, such as gender,

class, ethnicity, religion, status, and geographic origins, and culturally recognizable activities, social relationships, and affective stances (Ochs, 1992; Ochs and Schieffelin, 2008; Silverstein, 1976). Examining how children learn such associations through interactions with adults and peers is critical for understanding language contact phenomena like language shift as well as revitalization (Friedman, 2012; Garrett, 2007, 2012; Kulick, 1992; Makihara, 2005; Meek, 2010; Nonaka, 2012; Paugh, 2012a, 2012b; Riley, 2012). Consideration of scaling practices vis-à-vis the indexicality of linguistic varieties can offer another layer of complexity to language socialization analysis.

Through examination of children's social interactions across contexts, it is possible to explore "the diverse ways that scales are conceived, cultivated, practiced, and institutionalized" (Choksi, 2015:9). Studies of children's cultures demonstrate that peer-controlled settings facilitate children's exploration and negotiation of cultural and linguistic practices and ideologies as they socialize one another both through and to use language (Cekaite et al., 2014; Goodwin and Kyratzis, 2012). In child-controlled interactional spaces, children engage in active exploration of dominant ideologies and social structures, with the potential to both reproduce and challenge normative practices (Blum-Kulka et al., 2004; Cekaite and Aronsson, 2014; de León, 2007; Goodwin, 1990, 2006; Kyratzis, 2004; Kyratzis et al., 2001; Reynolds, 2008, 2010). Attention to children's social interactions, verbal play and improvisation, and imaginary play offers insights into their identity construction and impact on linguistic and cultural transmission and change over time (Aronsson, 2012; Evaldsson and Sahlström, 2014; García-Sánchez, 2014; Garrett, 2005, 2007; Howard, 2009; Kyratzis and de León, 2019; Kyratzis et al., 2010; Kyratzis, 2014; Minks, 2013; Paugh, 2005a, b, 2012a; Rindstedt and Aronsson, 2002; Schieffelin, 1990). As children organize their social interactions and peer activities, they explore, manipulate, and evaluate the various communicative resources available to them depending on their varied competencies. Through examination of how children frame their play, take up stances, shift footing, and rearrange participation frameworks as they signal alignment and disalignment (Goffman, 1974, 1981), we can explore how they engage with and produce scalar frameworks in their interactions with one another (see Kyratzis, 2019; de León, 2019).

This is particularly evident in children's imaginary role play during which they creatively employ and test out the linguistic boundaries and cultural expectations of their societies. Scalar hierarchies (linguistic and otherwise) made relevant by adults in other contexts can offer a wealth of resources for children's pretense and for negotiating their own power dynamics. As Goodwin and Kyratzis (2012:373) state, "Enacting stratified roles in pretend play provides children with resources for constituting hierarchical relationships among themselves and constructing the local social order of the peer group." Access to such resources among participants may be unequal in that the ability to jump or move between scales "depends on access to discursive resources that index and iconicize particular scale-levels, and such access is an object of inequality" (Blommaert, 2010:36). Multilingual skills (including code-switching) can be employed to distinguish recipients of talk and main actors in play, as well as orientations toward different play activities and shifts between imaginary and real worlds (Cromdal and Aronsson, 2000). In peer contexts, then, children socialize and can be socialized into powerful or marginalized identities through exclusionary linguistic and nonverbal practices (García-Sánchez, 2014, 2016; Goodwin, 1990, 2006). Children's multilingual play is a thus prime site for examining how children engage with the various cross-cutting scalar hierarchies that attribute value to the languages used around them. As they employ differentially scaled linguistic resources to negotiate their own power structures, children can redefine dominant ideologies and rescale languages, possibly even repositioning "heritage" or other vernacular codes on higher scales of value in the process of wielding power through the use of those codes (Jørgensen, 1998; see Kyratzis, this issue). Of course, the downscaling of marginalized codes—as well as dominant ones—is also possible.

3. Historical and sociolinguistic background

Dominica (population approximately 71,000) is a mountainous post-colonial island nation located between the French overseas departments of Martinique and Guadeloupe in the Eastern Caribbean. Its complex sociolinguistic situation was shaped by French and British colonial occupation, with the island changing hands at least seven times before becoming British in 1763, combined with importation of enslaved West Africans as a source of estate labor by both the British and French. Related to the geographical isolation of rural settlements from the two main towns that housed the British colonial administration, English became the language of urban settings and the elite, while Patwa emerged as the oral language of slaves and later the agriculturally based rural population after emancipation. Forging scalar frameworks that contrasted Patwa and English, and the people who spoke them, education officials and town residents strongly disparaged Patwa as the language of poor uneducated peasants and did not permit their children to speak it; English was institutionalized as the higher-scale language. Since independence in 1978, however, the state has promoted Patwa revitalization through language documentation efforts and events such as annual Creole Week celebrations and school spelling bees. Nevertheless, both languages index long-standing disparities related to socioeconomic class, education, rural versus urban origins, generation, and age. Rural adults claim that Patwa can harm children's acquisition of English and thus "inhibits scalar mobility" (Carr and Lempert, 2016:7), with implications for their future socioeconomic mobility. Like the wealthier town folk of the past, most rural adults tend to speak English to their children and do not allow them to speak Patwa in their presence, contributing to the language shift by ensuring that children acquire English as their first and primary language.

Despite expressing negative attitudes toward Patwa, however, many adults construct competing scalar frameworks that upscale Patwa in community settings for intimate communication and expressive functions, and many parents say that they

expect their children will speak at least some Patwa as adults. Patwa is often preferred over English for emotionally expressive speech acts like gossiping, arguing, joking, cursing, teasing, and assessing others—including speaking Patwa directly to children for affectively-marked disciplinary functions such as intensified reprimands, negative assessments, and directives. It is considered appropriate for informal contexts such as socializing with friends, hanging out on the road or at the rum shop, and working in the garden or bush. Most community adults' language practices are heteroglossic, but at the same time, there are gendered differences that have emerged in the course of the language shift related to certain occupations being more heavily dominated by men or women. For example, women play an important role in monitoring and discouraging children's Patwa usage and providing them with English through the occupations of childrearing and teaching in the spaces of the home and school, while men more frequently utilize Patwa in occupations such as farming and road construction in outside workspaces. In this way, Patwa and English fall across intersecting spatiotemporal scales whereby spaces and activities are associated with and appropriate for one language more than the other, and expectations for use are differentiated across developmental and generational time.

Such expectations also shift as people traverse various spaces over the course of a given day—for example, as children move from adult monitored indoor spaces of home and school to relatively unmonitored outdoor spaces of peer play after completing chores and schoolwork, or when preschool children are incorporated into older children's group play after a day at home with adult caregivers. A primary language socialization context for both girls and boys of differing ages is playing in large groups of children with little adult supervision. Most children in rural villages play with peers for 2 to 3 h a day or more on weekends and school vacations. Their play is usually relegated to the yard or bush since adults generally do not allow groups of children to "make noise" inside and disrupt the household. The open space of the yard, in contrast to enclosed adult-controlled spaces of the home or school, often facilitates multilingual play. When in adult-controlled spaces, children rarely speak Patwa but they may respond to adults' Patwa utterances, giving the impression that they have limited productive competence. But when alone with other children and away from adult supervision, many children employ Patwa in ways that even surprise their peers as they explore the range of their linguistic repertoires without being told "no Patwa" by adults. Children thus learn to navigate the spatial (home, school, yard, bush) and temporal (during school, when adults are present at home) restrictions placed on their language use.

Children's code-switching practices illustrate the associations of the languages with particular people, places, and functions—particularly that Patwa has become enregistered (Agha, 2005) as an adult language associated with adult status, roles, and activities and is identified with affective stances that complement or intensify those expressed through English (Paugh, 2005b, 2012a, b). This becomes evident when children use Patwa lexical items, expletives, and exclamations for affective marking and intensification within their English speech, such as curses like "*tèt papa'w*" (your father's head) or intensified directives like "*sòti la*" (come out of there). A code-switch into Patwa, however brief, can mark a shift in footing and signal alignment or disalignment with the activity at hand or stances of other participants, reconfiguring participation frameworks in the process. Further, employing a register brings into being particular identities and the practices related to them; Patwa can become a key resource in the creation of elaborate role play frames and characters, as will be explored below.

4. Methods and data

I investigated children's language use and play through a longitudinal language socialization study in one rural farming village in northern Dominica (see Paugh, 2012a for more details). The language socialization data included over 130 h of audio-video recorded social interactions among six language-learning children between 2 and 4 years of age and their families, peers, and other interlocutors at home and in the village. This data was complemented by participant observation in community and national events, observations and recordings of language use at the preschool and elementary school, and interviews with caregivers, community members, educational professionals, government officials, and language revitalization activists. Over 20 years of ethnographic research in Dominica inform my interpretations.

In the following, I analyze one extended stretch of imaginary play that is representative of children's multilingual role construction and language use as I observed and recorded it across families in the village. The peer group included 3-year-old focal child Reiston and his 11-year-old cousin Marcel, who were being fostered by their grandparents while their parents lived abroad, and their cousins who lived nearby, 9-year-old Junior and siblings 5-year-old Alex and 4-year-old Sherona. All the children were English dominant, but during role play they often produced complete Patwa sentences over several turns in contrast to the briefer Patwa borrowings and code-switches that characterized their regular English speech. Marcel in particular frequently took on the most powerful roles and directed the younger children in creative imaginary play; he also seemed to be the most fluent in both English and Patwa. On this particular sunny afternoon, the children were gathered in a shaded area of the concrete paved yard at Reiston and Marcel's home, under Marcel's supervision. Their grandfather had just returned from the garden when I arrived, but he left the children to their play as he went about various chores in the outdoor kitchen and banana field nearby. Unlike the boys' grandmother, who regularly monitored their language and sanctioned uses of Patwa, their grandfather was Patwa-dominant and rarely paid attention to their use of it. This gave them considerable freedom for their play in the yard when their grandmother was not present.

The following two sections analyze segments from an approximately 37-min long bout of videotaped and transcribed imaginary play that took place that afternoon. First, we see a primarily English-speaking teacher instructing his pupils at

school; next we see primarily Patwa-speaking hunters catching an animal in the bush. These play frames followed one another rather seamlessly, but are excerpted here due to space constraints (intervening interactions between the excerpts are summarized for brevity). Parts of the hunting role play were previously analyzed in a larger study of children's language socialization and peer interactions in Dominica (Paugh, 2012a). Here, the imaginary play analysis is expanded upon and further developed by integrating examination of children's scaling practices in order to get at the reproduction and transformation of linguistic ideologies as children construct their talk turn by turn and take up stances toward one another's contributions in play. In addition, the example is contrasted with the school role play that immediately preceded it, deepening the analysis through examination of the full peer play session. Children's rescaling practices are made particularly vivid through the contrast *between* the two imaginary episodes.

5. "Respect a teacher!": playing school in English

The role play begins when Marcel assembles material objects that set the stage for a pretend classroom: a sheet of metal roofing to serve as a chalkboard, a small piece of chalk, two large rectangular sheets of cardboard for the seating area, and a stick for a pointer and disciplinary tool. As the initiator and oldest child, Marcel claims the powerful role of teacher. To begin, he simply tells the other children, "Sit down there," while pointing at the cardboard. He does not explain the activity but relies on his props and verbal imperatives to trigger the group play. Children physically and verbally create places associated with adult activities that are appropriate for various language varieties—which simultaneously serve to create their sociodramatic play in turn as they enact adult roles. In character as schoolteacher, Marcel continues speaking English as he had been throughout the day, but shifts into a more standard school register for the duration of the school-focused play—speaking at a slower pace, referring to the children as "my class," and using such instructional directives as "Watch the board" and "Spell the word boy." Junior, Alex, and Sherona sit down, signaling their alignment with the activity and ratifying Marcel's role as teacher and their role as students. Reiston refuses to sit, however, until Marcel threatens, "I'll make you cry though." Reiston complies and after some wiggling around, the four children are quietly assembled in the cardboard classroom. Marcel begins the lesson by writing the word "boy" on his pretend chalkboard and questioning Reiston about it, but immediately faces resistance from his class:

Excerpt 1: Spelling lesson

1	Marcel:	Reisto. ((speaking very slowly and patiently)) You can spell?
2	Reiston:	Uh huh! ((stands up abruptly in an animated and comical way))
3	Marcel:	((turns to Sherona, speaking slowly)) Spell the word bo:y Shero.
4	Reiston:	((walks off the cardboard)) Uh hu::h!
5	Sherona:	((spelling out letter**s**)) B O I T.
6	Reiston:	((in the background)) Uh hu::h!
7	Marcel:	((points stick at Reiston as an example of a boy)) Look boy there. ((points stick at the word on the pretend chalkboard)) The first letter.
8	Sherona:	((spelling out letters)) B:: O::
9	(1)	
10	Marcel:	Spell the word boy.
11	Sherona:	((speaking but not spelling the word)) Bo:y.
12	Junior:	((laughs))

On lines 1, 3, 7, and 10, Marcel assumes the expert role of teacher by speaking slowly and carefully enunciating his utterance in English as he directs the children to spell, while physically positioning himself at the head of the classroom near the chalkboard. His language choice—a more standard variety of English than he usually speaks, and not Patwa—evokes scalar hierarchies that position English as the language of power and control in institutional settings, and serves as a contextualization cue (Gumperz, 1982) for the activity being undertaken. Reiston, however, refuses to play a complacent student as seen in his outbursts of "Uh huh!" on lines 2, 4, and 6. This could be interpreted as a lack of knowledge about classroom norms because of not yet attending school, however, he is familiar with this script as it is a regular in the group's pretense repertoire and he has been socialized into its norms through participation with his elder kin. Rather, he does not appear interested and shows disalignment by refusing to engage in the spelling lesson and moving out of the pretend classroom. Marcel turns to four-year-old Sherona (line 3), but she also appears unable—or unwilling—to complete the task. She spells the word "boy" incorrectly on line 5 before simply repeating the word on line 11. Junior's laughter following Sherona's turn (line 12) keys her utterance as inappropriate and comical, although it is unclear whether he interprets her move as insubordinate (resisting the teacher's control, acting as class clown) or incompetent (not knowing the correct spelling).

Following Excerpt 1 (not shown in the transcript), Marcel tries eliciting the spelling twice more from Sherona before moving on to Junior; he does not tell Sherona the correct way to spell "boy," thus further contextualizing the activity as pretend and not actually instructional. Then, as we see in Excerpt 2 below, Junior similarly struggles with a spelling task despite that he is well into primary school at age 9. In response, Marcel shifts footing from enacting a patient, attentive teacher to an impatient,

frustrated one that uses corporal punishment, both drawing on and socializing classroom expectations. For each child who gives an unsatisfactory answer or behaves incorrectly, he gives them a smack on the hand with his pointer:

Excerpt 2: "I don't have *pasyans*"

1	Marcel:	((to Junior)) Your word is got. Spell it.
2	Junior:	((looks around blankly))
3	Marcel:	((points at the chalkboard)) Look it under your name.
4	Junior:	C-
5	Marcel:	Come.
6	(1)	
7	Marcel:	((impatiently)) Come!
8	Reiston:	((covers face with arms and pretends to cry)
9	Marcel:	((more impatiently)) Come!
10	Sherona:	((laughs, then pretends to cry))
11	Junior:	((stands and slowly walks to Marcel))
12	Marcel:	((takes Junior's hand)) I don't have *pasyans.* (I don't have patience.)
13	Sherona:	[((pretends to cry))
14	Marcel:	[((hits Junior's hand with stick)) G ((hits Junior's hand with stick)) O =
15	Grandfather:	((speaking fast and low from inside the kitchen)) *Pa ba sé zanfan la kou.* (Don't hit those children.)
16	Marcel:	= ((hits Junior's hand with stick)) T.
17	Marcel:	((to Grandfather)) Not hit I hitting them. Play *wi* I playing with them!
18	Junior:	((returns to the cardboard and sits down))
19	Reiston:	((runs to Marcel, holding out his hand to be hit))
20	Marcel:	((ignores Reiston))
21	Reiston:	((whining)) Give me:::
22	Marcel:	[((lightly hits Reiston's hand three times with the stick))
23	Sherona:	[((pretends to cry))
24	Marcel:	Sharo.
25	Sherona:	((pretends to cry))
26	Marcel:	Sharo. Your [word is cat.
27	Reiston:	[((looking at Sherona)) I not crying.
28	Reiston:	((to Sherona)) You crying? ((speaking fast)) I not crying! YOU crying!
29	Marcel:	Sharo!
30	Sherona:	[((pretends to cry))
31	Reiston:	[((walks to Junior and quickly sits by him)) Me and Junior not crying *non.*
32	Sherona:	((stares at Marcel, whimpering))
33	Marcel:	((speaking in a low tone)) Sharo get out of my class.
34	Sherona:	((sucks teeth in disgust while glaring at Marcel))
35	Marcel:	((slowly walks over to Sherona)) You have - you don't have to says tyups [the sound of sucking teeth]. Show your hand.
36	Sherona:	((puts out hand))
37	Marcel:	Respect a teacher. ((hits Sherona's hand repeatedly with stick)) One. Two. Three.
38	Sherona:	((grimaces))
39	Marcel:	Now come. ((grabs Sherona's arm and pulls her up from the cardboard)) Come. Get out of my class!
40	Sherona:	((cries, seemingly seriously now))
41	Marcel:	((stops pulling Sherona's arm as she cries louder))
42	Sherona:	((sits down on the cardboard))

When Marcel directs Junior to spell the word "got" on lines 1 and 3, Junior looks around blankly and begins with an incorrect letter on line 4, enacting the role of a disobedient student. Marcel then keys frustration with several impatient directives to "come" on lines 5, 7, and 9, and one of the few in-character uses of Patwa in the classroom situation: "I don't have *pasyans,*" on line 12. His Patwa code-switch signals an escalation in seriousness and is followed by corporal punishment as he smacks Junior's hand with the stick three times for each letter of "got" (lines 14 and 16). This interactional move serves to upscale Patwa as a language of value in that it signals the right of authoritative persons like teachers and older peers to monitor and control children's actions. Reiston pretends to cry (line 8) and is imitated by Sherona (lines 10 and 13), acting as punished or fearful children. Marcel's grandfather, who has been silent since entering the outdoor kitchen, overhears the crying and issues a scolding directive to not hit the children, "*Pa ba sé zanfan la kou,*" on line 15. Like Marcel's code-switch into Patwa to indicate his loss of patience, this scold is also in Patwa, again evoking adult authority and rescaling Patwa as a

powerful code for the discipline of children vis-à-vis English as the "normal" language used with them. These indexical links are confirmed by Marcel's quick denial in English, thereby reaffirming and socializing broader scalar age and status hierarchies despite his control of the peer play: "Not hit I hitting them. Play *wi* I playing with them!" (line 17). Marcel's limited "real" authority to direct the children is made apparent in this interaction despite the authority conveyed to him through control of the school-related props and language. Corporal punishment is acceptable in the school play frame, however, as is indicated when Reiston subsequently requests to be disciplined like the others (lines 19 and 21). Marcel appeases him despite it being an unlikely demand from a schoolchild (line 22).

Sherona continues to pretend cry (line 23), drawing Marcel's attention to her. He then attempts to maintain the school frame through another spelling elicitation (lines 24, 26, and 29), now calmly and carefully instructing her, "Your word is cat." When she fails to answer and continues pretend crying (lines 30 and 32), Marcel shifts footing and demands that she leave his class (line 33). Sherona refuses his directive by drawing air through her teeth to make a sharp sucking sound that is known as "suck teeth" or "tyups" (line 34), a gesture that indicates disgust, annoyance, or disappointment. Here it challenges the teacher's (and Marcel's) authority, and Marcel responds with a scold to not "say tyups" and a directive for Sherona to hold out her hand for punishment (line 35). Sherona complies, indicating that she is still upholding the play frame (line 36). Marcel commands "Respect a teacher!" and hits her repeatedly with the stick (line 37) before pulling her up by the arm and ordering, "Get out of my class!" on line 39. This prompts Sherona to cry louder in a more serious manner (line 40). As the play verges on reality—with the grandfather able to overhear—Marcel backs off (line 41) and leaves Sherona on the cardboard/in the classroom (line 42). Ultimately, the close proximity of the adult authority and potential consequences of being caught harming a younger child serve to regulate his actions and speech, rescaling the age and status hierarchy in relation to the shifting peer versus adult-child participation frameworks.

Marcel tries to keep the school play frame going over the course of approximately 17 min, despite his pretend pupils' oppositional stances toward his demands. He resorts to a number of tactics to hold or regain the children's attention including directing their gaze to the pretend chalkboard, using corporal punishment, shaming them, kicking them out of the play, and eventually going inside to get more props—some Sunday school books—to augment the construction of the play frame. Notably Marcel speaks almost strictly English for constructing and negotiating the entire play frame with only two unique uses of Patwa: asserting "I don't have *pasyans*" three times as in Excerpt 2 (line 12) as well as calling the children *mal élivé* (badly brought up) twice later in the transcript when they disobey. Marcel's brief code-switches signal shifts in footing as he admonishes his unruly students and tries to manipulate their behavior; they also evoke scales of value that position Patwa as a powerful language for scolding and negative evaluation (as seen in his grandfather's admonishments as well). Yet English is positioned on a higher scale as the unquestioned institutional and de facto school language. Patwa is not used to construct the school frame or spelling lesson—Marcel does not use it to instruct them or tell his pupils to spell any Patwa words. Patwa is thereby contextualized as low-scale vis-à-vis English in the school setting and is not appropriate for the content, though a competing scale of age-graded language use becomes relevant and thereby gives Patwa higher value for particular functions. Yet the school frame does not appear very compelling to the younger children, who display disalignment and creativity by refusing to act as "good" students. This could be because of Marcel imposing formality through using standard English and calm or negative affective stances, as well as requiring the children to sit in one confined space, be quiet, raise their hands or reply to questions to speak, and answer properly and respectfully or face punishment.

There are also gendered scales at play. Schoolteachers in the children's community, as in other areas of Dominica, are predominantly women. Even though the pretend teacher in this example is a male child, the school space and teaching activity are subtly feminized. This association emerges directly at a later point in this lesson in response to a book-related question:

Excerpt 3: "Miss!"

1 Marcel: Tell me what - Junior tell me what you learn about the book.
2 Junior: Miss! Miss I learn - I learn a - a man die.
3 Marcel: ((nods approvingly))

On line 1, Marcel asks Junior to describe what he learned from one of the Sunday school books that he added to the play. In a moment of alignment with the school activity, Junior plays a student eager to answer the teacher's question. He calls out a gender marked title as is polite when addressing teachers—"Miss!"—in his answer on line 2. Marcel does not acknowledge or attempt to repair the error to the masculine title "Mr."; rather he focuses only on the answer to the question and nods to indicate his approval on line 3. While English is used in many spaces where men and women meet—the village council office, credit union, church, etc.—feminized spaces in the village, like the home and school when children are present, tend to be more associated with English than many male domains, like the garden and bush. These separations are fluid and vary by family and individual, but overall there are patterns that children perceive and replicate in their play, as seen in Excerpt 3. This becomes even more evident as the play in this group shifts to the male-dominated outdoor space of the bush as explored below.

6. *"Annou Kouvè'y!"* (let's cover it!): capturing an animal in Patwa[1]

Not long after Excerpt 3, the children strongly signal their disalignment with Marcel's controlling behavior and school activity by fully leaving the space of the pretend classroom. Also during this time, the grandfather leaves the kitchen and goes into the banana field behind the house where he is out of hearing (and monitoring) range. After running around for a few minutes, the group begins to initiate new imaginary play that moves from the English-dominant formal classroom space to the non-human controlled outdoor space and more Patwa-dominant male activity of catching and butchering an animal. First, Reiston removes the cardboard, thus doing away with the classroom and the activity of playing school. Marcel unsuccessfully struggles to get the cardboard back and then flops on the ground as if he has given up. Then, as we see in Excerpt 4 below, Reiston puts the cardboard on top of Marcel and repeatedly hits him with it before seizing the opportunity to create a new play frame. He covers Marcel with the cardboard as if it is a blanket and narrates a brief activity where Marcel becomes a person who is sleeping. The others join in, but Reiston's attempt does not last long—Sherona attempts to restart the school frame, while Junior takes the play in another direction by code-switching into Patwa:

Excerpt 4: Marcel is sleeping

1	Reiston:	((putting the cardboard over Marcel)) Let's cover - cover Marcel. Let's cover Marcel. He sleeping.
2	Junior:	((pushes cardboard on Marcel)) *Annou ay*. *Annou ay*. (Let's go. Let's go [cover Marcel].)
3	Sherona:	((repeating Junior and pushing the cardboard on Marcel)) *Annou ay, annou ay, annou ay, annou ay*.
4	Reiston:	((shoves Sherona)) Mm! He sleeping.
5	Sherona:	((stands back)) *Annou ay*.
6	Reiston:	((pulling another piece of cardboard from under Alex, whispering fast)) Let's cover him. Let's cover him. Let's cover him.
7	Alex:	((stands up))
8	Reiston:	((takes the cardboard)) Cover him. He sleeping. Cover him. Cover him.
9	Reiston:	[((pulls the cardboard over Marcel's head))
10	Junior:	[((helps Reiston cover Marcel)) *Annou* cover him, *annou* cover him. (Let's cover him, let's cover him.)
11	Reiston:	*Annou* cover him aye!
12	((the children laugh, except for Marcel under the cardboard))	
13	Junior:	((stepping back)) We cover him. We cover him. We cover him.
14	Sherona:	I going. ((walks to the pretend chalkboard))
15	Reiston:	((climbs on Marcel, bounces up and down, laughing))
16	Sherona:	((banging on the chalkboard, loudly punctuating each syllable)) WHAT IS THAT EVERYBODY?
17	((the boys play and laugh while Sherona bangs on the chalkboard))	

On line 1, Reiston launches new play by covering Marcel with the cardboard, recruiting the others through the inclusive imperative "let's," and defining Marcel's actions as sleep. On line 2, Junior quickly aligns with Reiston by helping to put the cardboard on Marcel and partially repeating Reiston's command, but in Patwa, "*Annou ay*." The code-switch signals another shift in the play that soon becomes clear. Meanwhile, Sherona repeats Junior's utterance several times on line 3, showing alignment with the activity and using Patwa as she imitates or "shadows" (Björk-Willén, 2007) the older child. Junior's use of Patwa and Sherona's quick uptake of it signals a rescaling of language varieties whereby the English of the school play frame is no longer relevant. At first Reiston rejects Sherona's attempt to join by physically shoving her and implying that she would wake Marcel: "Mm! He sleeping" on line 4. Sherona complies by stepping back, but continues her attempt at verbal participation on line 5 by repeating "*Annou ay*." Junior then more fully takes over narration of the pretend play with a hybrid Patwa-English recycling of Reiston's earlier inclusive imperative "Let's cover him" by directing "*Annou* cover him" on line 10. Reiston enthusiastically imitates him on line 11, "*Annou* cover him aye!" When Marcel is covered with the cardboard, Junior surveys their work and announces that the task is finished on line 13. Sherona appears to interpret this shift in footing in the type or frame of play as an opportunity to gain the floor by returning the activity to playing school with *her* in control. She exits the play frame by telling the others "I going" on line 14 and walks to the pretend chalkboard. Banging on the chalkboard, she punctuates each syllable carefully in English as she attempts to secure the boys' attention and alignment with "WHAT IS THAT EVERYBODY?" (line 16). The boys ignore her, however, as they pounce on Marcel, laugh, and talk all at once. A more exciting form of pretense has begun.

The play continues with Reiston and Junior wrestling on Marcel, Alex watching as if trying to figure out his role in the participation framework, and Sherona off to the side looking at a book from the school play. However, when Sherona claims to see a picture of me in a book, Reiston is distracted; Junior seizes control of the play and fully reframes it as catching an animal played by Marcel:

[1] As noted in Section 4, portions of the transcript data from the "hunting an animal" episode were previously analyzed for different purposes in *Playing with Languages: Children and Change in a Caribbean Village*, published by Berghahn Books (Paugh, 2012a, Chapter 6).

Excerpt 5: Narrating the capture in Patwa

1 Sherona: ((to AP)) Amy. Look Amy! ((pointing at a picture in the book)) Look you.
2 AP: Uh uh!
3 Sherona: Yes!
4 Reiston: ((looks at the book)) *Ga!* That you?
(Look at that! Is that you?)
5 Junior: ((suddenly jumps up, speaking loudly and urgently)) *Annou koupé'y. Pa sizé anlè'y! Pa sizé anlè'y!*
((pulling the cardboard from underneath Reiston)) *Bouden i ké waché.*
(Let's cut it. Don't sit on top of it! Don't sit on top of it! Its belly will come out.)
6 Reiston: ((gets up, laughs))
7 Junior: ((putting the cardboard on Marcel)) *Nou kay kouvè'y non. Annou kouvè'y. Annou kouvè'y. I mò.*
(We're going to cover it (tag). Let's cover it. Let's cover it. It's dead.)
8 Reiston: ((repeating Junior)) *I mò.*
(It's dead.)
9 Junior: *I mò! Wé!*
10 Reiston: ((repeating Junior)) *Wé!*
11 Junior: *Dé pat li.*
(Its two paws.)
12 Reiston: ((repeating Junior)) *Dé pat li.*
13 Junior: ((grabbing Marcel's feet, counting)) *Dé pat li, yon.*
(Its two paws, one.)
((the boys laugh, sing, and yell over one another))
14 Sherona: ((walks to the boys and shakes her stick)) Everybody stay well! ((walks back to the chalkboard))
15 ((the boys continue laughing and yelling))

When Reiston is momentarily distracted by Sherona and the book on lines 1 through 4, Junior shifts footing through the use of Patwa and an excited affective stance to narrate new events: he and Reiston become hunters who have caught an animal, Marcel, that they are trying to cover with the cardboard. He jumps up and orders the others not to sit on the animal in Patwa on line 5. Central to understanding this shift is that when hunting and butchering meat, men tend to cover the carcass with cardboard, a tarp, or banana leaves to keep flies off until the meat can be taken away. It is likely that Reiston's covering of Marcel initially prompted Junior's change in language in his partial recycling of Reiston's directive "*Annou ay*" on line 2 of Excerpt 4. In turn, Junior's use of Patwa evokes another scale of value where Patwa is the powerful language of a male-dominated outdoor activity, thus serving as a critical contextualization cue and helping Junior control the play for what becomes an extended period of time. Further, similar to when Marcel began the school lesson, Junior does not *tell* the other children that they are pretending to hunt and butcher an animal. This becomes clear through his use of Patwa for imperatives to cut and cover the animal (lines 5 and 7) and to describe it as *mò* "dead" (lines 7 and 9), while covering it with cardboard (line 7) and referring to Marcel's feet as animal paws, *pat*, rather than human feet, *pyé* (lines 11 and 13). Junior issues the same inclusive imperative used by Reiston in English in Excerpt 4 on line 6, "Let's cover him," but fully in Patwa: "*Annou kouvè'y*" (line 7), building on the prior frame (during transcription, Marcel interpreted Junior's use of the third-person Patwa pronoun *y* as meaning "it" rather than "he" or "she," which it can also refer to, as Junior was treating him like an animal). Reiston indicates alignment with the new frame by getting up from Marcel on line 6, repeating Junior's Patwa utterances on lines 8, 10, and 12, and matching his heightened affective stance throughout—that of an excited hunter who succeeded at the kill. While the boys continue screaming, wrestling, and laughing, Sherona makes another attempt to shift footing by walking up to the boys with a stick and ordering, like teachers do when they want students to behave, "Now everybody stay well!" on line 14. Despite that this preschool age child has acquired the English language, linguistic conventions, and embodied actions used by her older peers for playing school, the boys refuse to abandon the new role play to join her. Sherona is unable to break into the Patwa-dominated play with the English school register, which is downscaled in the current play frame.

This interaction serves as a key moment of language socialization. The older child displays understandings of domain-specific language use and rescales Patwa as a desirable code for enacting masculine roles in the play frame. The younger children enthusiastically reproduce the utterances and positive affective stances accompanying them, without adult sanction. While in other contexts the use of Patwa may be disempowering to rural adults and discouraged for children, in this child-controlled context it is upscaled as an affectively potent tool for gaining control of the interactional frame and creating compelling sociodramatic play. Further, the Patwa role construction does not prompt humorous or mocking stances toward the activities, roles, or linguistic construction of the event as "rural," "backward," or lower class; rather, use of Patwa resources seems to heighten the positive affect displayed by the children as they excitedly engage in the vivid drama. At the same time, the children code-switch into their more familiar everyday code, English, for off-stage comments, questions, and directions. For example, in a segment not reproduced here, they systematically switch languages as they alternate between constructing the play in Patwa and planning to hide Marcel's book, a prop from playing school, in English (see Paugh, 2012a:188–189 for more detail on this).

For the next few minutes, the children cover and uncover Marcel and wrestle on top of him, with extensive overlapped speech and noises as the play becomes rather chaotic and physically rough. Then Alex more fully inserts himself into the participation

framework and refines the event by specifying the type of animal being captured and embodying Junior's directive to cut it. This launches a shift in footing in the play as the children have a more formal negotiation of roles in English, as shown in Excerpt 6:

Excerpt 6: It's a pig

1	Alex:	*Kochon* ((pretends to slice Junior's back with his outstretched hand)). *I kochon.*
		(Pig. It's a pig.)
2	Alex:	((moves to Marcel, slicing with his hand)) *I kochon.*
3	Reiston:	((banging hand on Marcel's back)) Hachup hachup hachup hachup!
4	Sherona:	((banging hand on Junior's back)) Hachup hachup hachup!
5	Reiston:	((turns to Junior and bangs hand on his back)) Hachup!
6	Marcel:	((looks up at Junior and Sherona, laughing)) Mommy and daddy.
7	Reiston:	Yes.
8	Marcel:	((nodding toward Junior and Sherona, laughing)) Mommy and daddy.
9	Alex:	((steps back))
10	Reiston:	((flops on Marcel's back and hugs his neck))
11	Junior:	WHAT all you saying? Me and - mommy and daddy? Shero is mommy and I is daddy.
12	Junior:	((pointing at Alex and Reiston)) And two brothers.
13	Reiston:	And two brothers.
14	Alex:	((pointing at Marcel)) *I kochon.*
		(It's a pig.)
15	Sherona:	I not a mommy though.
16	Marcel:	((softly)) I not a pig.
17	Sherona:	I not a mommy! ((walks to the veranda step and sits))

In spite of his peripheral participation and silence throughout both play frames, Alex makes a key contribution to the next direction in the play. On lines 1 and 2 of this excerpt, he identifies the animal as a pig, *kochon*, and enhances the non-verbal action by using his hand as a knife to cut it. Reiston aligns with this shift but alters the action by chopping rather than cutting, making a sound that villagers use to represent the noise made by a machete, "hachup," on line 3. Sherona imitates him on line 4. When Marcel notices that Sherona is participating again, he steps out of character to attribute her and Junior new gender-appropriate roles as "mommy" and "daddy" on lines 6 and 8. Reiston and Junior ratify this attribution (lines 7 and 11) and Junior expands on it by designating Alex and Reiston as brothers, thus creating an imaginary family (line 12). Sherona, however, rejects the feminine role assigned to her. While she plays "mommy" in other contexts, this is a less desirable and more passive role in the current play frame and participation framework, as she would once again be excluded from the primary activity, the hunt and butchering of the pig. She voices her opposing stance, "I is not a mommy," and embodies her rejection by leaving the play space for the veranda step, thus forfeiting any role (lines 15 and 17). Marcel softly states "I not a pig" on line 16 following Sherona's objection. Given that Marcel continues embodying the role and in fact guards it closely (calling himself a "pig" at other points in the play), this appears to be commentary on the younger child's competence in imaginary play—Sherona is not actually a mommy, nor is Marcel a pig, but both can become these things in pretense. Notably, while the pig role (related to the Patwa-dominant outdoor space of the bush) is described in Patwa, all negotiation over the roles of mommy, daddy, and brothers (related to the English-dominant home environment for children) takes place in English. The children thereby maintain some scalar frameworks, such as regarding gendered roles and expectations, while simultaneously challenging others, such as age-graded restrictions on children's language use, namely of Patwa.

Over the next few minutes the boys begin climbing on Marcel and talking over one another again, and Sherona attempts to rejoin as a hunter. But despite repeatedly making clear her disalignment with the proposed distribution of roles, she is once again attributed the role of mommy by Reiston just minutes later, as Junior continues his narration:

Excerpt 7: "Mommy go for yam!"

1	Junior:	*Mwen ka haché'y. Tèt li gou!*
		(I'm cutting it. Its head tastes [good]!)
2	Junior:	((to the others)) *Zò pa ka koupé tèt li.*
		(You are not cutting its head.)
3	Reiston:	((looks up at Sherona)) Mommy! Go for - mommy go for yam!
4	Junior:	[*I pa mò. I pa mò.*
		(It isn't dead. It isn't dead [re: pretend pig].)
5	Reiston:	[((to Sherona)) Mommy go for yam!
6	Sherona:	((makes a throwing gesture with hands)) Look all you food. Cook your food.
7		((the three boys pretend to chop Marcel))
8	Sherona:	I NOT a mommy. (1) And I is a - a head teacher though. ((shaking head)) I is NOT a mommy.
9	Junior:	Well *nou ka koupé'y*.
		(Well we are cutting it.)
10	Sherona:	((sits and watches the boys wrestle with Marcel))

Junior maintains his skillful construction of the play in Patwa, elaborating on the condition and taste of the pig in lines 1, 2, and 4. Sherona, however, is unable to fully participate despite her many attempts to join as a hunter or reframe the play as a teacher. On lines 3 and 5, Reiston attempts to include her by addressing her in English as "mommy" and sending her to harvest yams, presumably to accompany a pork dinner. The suggestion of a make-believe family by three of the boys puts the pretense in recognizable cultural terms where a father and his sons would come home with meat for the mother to cook for the family. In other words, the gendered roles and activities give cohesion to the imaginary play by defining everyone's expected contribution and incorporating Sherona in a ratified participant role that makes cultural sense. Further, their attempts to attribute Sherona a gender normative identity in turn construct her participation as a hunter as culturally problematic (García-Sánchez, 2016; Kulick and Schieffelin, 2004). Yet, a feminine role like housewife is downscaled in the hunting play frame vis-à-vis the available masculine roles. This 4-year-old desires a more powerful role in this imaginary context where different scales of value are operating—either with an active part in the male-dominated (Patwa) activity or in the professional job of teacher in the (English) school frame. On line 6, she rejects the mother role with the forceful gesture of throwing imaginary food while verbally asserting herself in English: "Look all you food. Cook your food." As the boys continue playing, on line 8 she declares "I NOT a mommy" and asserts that she is a "head teacher," which is a school's principal and thus in a position of significant control over the staff and student body. No one ratifies her claim to be head teacher, though, nor do they suggest an alternative role that is less gendered-marked but thematically consistent. Sherona avoids the stereotypically female task of cooking but also forfeits a ratified participant role that goes with the hunters and the pig, effectively marginalizing her from the play.

Following this excerpt (and not reproduced here), Junior continues the discursive construction of the play in Patwa, producing a number of complete Patwa sentences such as "*Mwen pa ka tjwé kochon pou i mòdé mwen*" (I'm not killing the pig for it to bite me) and "*Eh, i pòkò mò ou sav. I pòkò mò*" (Eh, it isn't dead yet you know. It isn't dead yet). This excites the children even more and Marcel appears to be getting hurt as they boys "cut" him; he then shifts footing by jumping up from the cardboard and throwing off his passive role as a caught animal. He calls out, "Ting ling, Ting ling! Time to eat people!", and begins chasing the children, who laugh and run away from him as he tries to "eat" and "hunt" them, using both Patwa and English to narrate the scenario. Then, just as they begin negotiating the format of the new pretense, Marcel's grandfather returns from the banana field and scolds Marcel in Patwa for not completing his chores. The lengthy stretch of multilingual play ends as Marcel heads to the kitchen and the younger children play by themselves until Marcel is done with his chores.

7. Discussion

In their exploration of adult roles and cultural norms in unmonitored imaginary play, children can rescale linguistic varieties and associated identities, at least temporarily, through their situated interactions—all without explicitly discussing language choice or appropriateness. In the two imaginary play frames analyzed here, playing school and hunting a pig, there was very little metalinguistic commentary. Yet, the children made important statements about language value and use through the stances they took toward the construction of the play. This becomes particularly vivid when we contrast the two role play episodes. In both, fantasy play frames and roles were signaled through language and register choice, along with paralinguistic features and use of props from around the home and yard. However, English was the language of in-character play in the classroom as well as out-of-character negotiation across both play frames, while Patwa was the in-character language for acting out and narrating the animal hunt and only briefly for disciplinary functions in the school frame. The children drew on associations with both languages to signal shifts in footing toward the activities through language choice as they took on more serious demeanors (when playing school in English) or frantic active ones (when catching and butchering an animal in Patwa). The two play frames differed in the organization of participation frameworks, desirability of roles, and level and type of affective involvement.

The ways in which the imaginary places themselves were produced evoked ideologies about English indexing indoor formal spaces and Patwa indexing outdoor activities. In the school example, two cardboard sheets and a chalkboard made from metal roofing created a closed classroom space that was clearly demarcated visually. The children's participation was signaled non-verbally as they moved in and out of that space. Verbally, Marcel commenced the lesson by telling the children to sit on the cardboard as he positioned himself in front of the pretend chalkboard, and threatened to throw Sherona out of the classroom when she did not comply (Excerpt 2). In contrast, the hunt in the bush was not bounded, instead revolving around one child's body and the cardboard used to cover him. The children moved freely in the outdoor space, although Sherona could exit the play frame by going back to the pretend chalkboard when she tried to play school (Excerpts 4 and 5) and the veranda step when she protested the mommy role in the animal hunt (Excerpts 6 and 7). The use of standard English contextualized the classroom space and instructional activities that took place inside it. In contrast, the use of Patwa contextualized the outdoor masculine space of the hunt.

Through their construction of these imaginary spaces, the children did not challenge ideologies about English being the language of institutional settings like school and Patwa the language of outdoor settings like the bush, yet they rescaled these linguistic resources within the peer play context. While in other settings Patwa is downscaled as inferior to English and not a language for children, here it is upscaled as a power code through which children could take on positions of authority, direct one another's actions, and secure valued pretend roles. We see that children like Junior and Marcel with degrees of competency in *both* English and Patwa could become key actors and directors of peer play, empowering them to

shape the actions and speech of other children (also see Cromdal, 2004; Jørgensen, 1998). The children used both languages to differing degrees depending on their competencies to accomplish shifts in frame, footing, and participation structures in ways that elevated Patwa in their imaginary pretense, thus upscaling the language in the context of children's play versus other communicative events.

Further, while both Marcel and Junior sustained the play frames they introduced for some time, there was much more enthusiastic uptake of Junior's animal hunt frame. Maintaining the school frame was a struggle for Marcel, in contrast to how he finally had to deter the children from the pig hunt as he was getting hurt by the increasingly rowdy physical play. This could be due to the activity and the way rough and tumble actions were central to it rather than the passive positioning of children in school, but also because of the excited affective stances it evoked and the verbal creativity it allowed the participants versus the predetermined answers expected in Marcel's school frame (spelling a word, reiterating a book plot). In contrast to the restrained key of playing school, the pig hunt was active and frenzied, with the children climbing on each other, talking over one another, making noise, and being relatively unconfined spatially. Junior was able to exert considerable control over the direction of the play through his Patwa narration, constructing an exciting pretend activity that drew in the other children and created, however inadvertently, a context for the transmission and practice of Patwa through *peer* language socialization. The prestige that this role conveyed to him—as evidenced by the other children's validation of and eager participation in the play frame—suggests a revaluing or rescaling of Patwa in a positive way that may transcend the interactional moment as children reconceptualize the relations between Patwa and the identities that it indexes. Patwa could have been used to index subordinate and undesirable positions in the play, or the children could have rejected Junior's use of Patwa given that they all could have participated in its English construction. But they did not. In taking up Junior's code choice, building upon it, and rejecting an English-dominant play frame, the children engaged in rescaling practices that positively associated Patwa with (masculine) agency, heightened affective stances, and fun.

At the same time, the children's language choice brought to bear gendered scales that have emerged in villages over the course of the language shift, whereby women and the spaces they control (home, school) tend to be associated with English while men and the rural outdoor spaces in which their work takes place (garden, road, bush) tend to be associated with Patwa. Domestic roles like mother or housekeeper and professional roles like teacher or nurse are carried out primarily or strictly in English, while rural male roles like farmer or hunter entail more use of Patwa. Such associations between the languages and gendered identities emerged in this peer group when Marcel was called “Miss” as a teacher (Excerpt 3) and when the boys identified strongly with the Patwa-speaking hunter role while excluding Sherona from the hunt by relegating her to the role of mother (Excerpts 6 and 7). The boys built shared alignment toward the masculine activity and roles through using Patwa and relevant embodied actions, while Sherona was marginalized by her rejection of a culturally acceptable feminine role.

Overall, this study demonstrates how children can manipulate the complex scaling practices they are exposed to as a potent resource for creativity, enjoyment, power wielding, and, critically, language socialization of one another into multilingual practices and parameters for their use. In the peer play context, it is beneficial to have varied linguistic abilities, as what is negative in one context (such as around teachers or parents) can be positive during collaborative, yet competitive, peer interaction. In the play examined here, the children traversed multiple scales of differentiation and rescaled Patwa, at least temporarily, to a language of relevance and value (Blommaert, 2010). Speaking English did not guarantee status in situated social interaction given these competing scales. It remains to be seen if children's symbolic elevation of Patwa and its associated social identities through enacting roles that index adult status, independence, and power (cf. Mortimer, 2016) can transcend the boundaries of their imaginary play and increase its relevance in everyday life.

Transcription conventions

The spelling of *Patwa*, rather than *Patois*, follows the orthography developed in *Dominica's English-Creole Dictionary* (Fontaine, 2003). All Patwa speech was transcribed with this orthography. The following conventions were used to transcribe recorded social interaction:

italics	Patwa speech
underline	English glosses of Patwa speech
CAPITALS	Emphasis
:	Elongated speech
(1)	Pause between utterances in seconds
((action))	Non-verbal action
?	Rising intonation, question
!	Exclamation
[	Overlapping speech
=	Adjacent turns with no interval between them, with the second turn “latched” onto but not overlapping the first turn
-	Cut-off or self-interrupted speech

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Amy L. Paugh is a Professor of Anthropology at James Madison University. Her research investigates language socialization, children's cultures, multilingualism, language ideologies, and language about food in Dominica and the United States. She is the author of *Playing with Languages: Children and Change in a Caribbean Village*. Her research has been published in such journals as *Language in Society*, *Journal of Linguistic Anthropology*, *Discourse & Society*, *Text & Talk*, and *Time & Society*.